



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Valor North Austin

School Website: <https://www.valoreducation.org/northaustin/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Valor North Austin (VNA) presents a partial alignment with classical education, with clear indications of a liberal-arts, humanities-forward orientation (e.g., Latin, history, integrated humanities programs, and a capstone/advisor structure) and explicit reference to a classical testing pathway (Classical Learning Test). However, public materials from the school's North Austin site do not publicly articulate core religious/metaphysical foundations (theology, liturgy, liturgical practice) or explicit assertions about formation of virtue and wisdom as telos, nor do they openly describe Pedagogy elements such as Socratic seminars, scholé days, or a regimented grammar-logic-rhetoric progression. The result is a cautious classification of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with notable strength in curriculum-oriented clues (Latin, humanities, capstone) but lacking explicit, fully developed religious, metaphysical framing and several pedagogy indicators that would push it toward CLASSICAL.

Key strengths observed in public materials:

- Explicit classical framing via CLT10 (Classical Learning Test) and a humanities-forward curriculum (Upper School Humanities, IHP) alongside a dedicated Capstone program and a Latin program. These elements demonstrate a curricular orientation consistent with classical schooling in structure and content (e.g., humanities, integration of classical disciplines) rather than purely secular or contemporary-density approaches. Evidence includes the CLT10 description and Upper School Humanities (IHP) entries.
- Public materials show structured faculty roles (Headmaster, deans, language and humanities teachers, CAPSTONE advisor) and a formal staff directory, suggesting a coherent, mentorship-oriented faculty model typical of classical schools, though without explicit descriptive language about virtue formation.

Caveats that pull the classification toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL:

- No explicit, public articulation of theology, liturgy, worship, or canonical religious communal practices on the observed pages; no explicit statements about virtue formation, telos, or permanent ideas (truth, goodness, beauty) as metaphysical anchors in the public materials. The absence of explicit religious/metaphysical grounding is a barrier to CLASSICAL across Element 1.
- Pedagogy section does not clearly cite Socratic seminars, scholé, or a rigorous, grade-by-grade movement through grammar, logic, rhetoric in the published materials; memory or chant-based pedagogy is not evidenced in the observed public content. This reduces the strength of a full classical pedagogy claim (Element 4).
- While there is strong curricular mention (Latin, history, humanities), the explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framework, grammar-logic-rhetoric progression, and other hallmark classical signals are not overtly published in the publicly accessible pages. This weighs Element 3 toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public materials do not publicly articulate theology, liturgy, communal worship, or transcendental moral realism; absence of explicit religious metaphysical framing in the observed pages. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords (truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder) largely absent; Negative signals (secularism, values-clarification) not evidenced in the public text. Overall: 0 positive keyword hits; 0

negative keyword hits in the observed material context. Why this rating: Lacks explicit religious/metaphysical foundations in publicly accessible content.

- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: CLT10 (Classical Learning Test) presence signals classical orientation; explicit humanities and capstone components (IHP; Humanities). Headed by a structured faculty, with a focus on classical-style assessment pathways. Positive keyword analysis: Keywords aligned with classical aims observed: Classical (CLT10), Latin, Humanities (IHP), Capstone, integrated humanities. 5 positive signals; 0 negative signals among the observed terms. Why this rating: Clear classical curricular and programmatic orientation, but without explicit telos-language (virtue formation) in public statements.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Public mentions of Latin, history, and humanities across K-12 offerings; presence of CAPSTONE and IHP. Fewer explicit references to grammar/logic/rhetoric or Great Books, which are standard markers of a full classical curriculum. Positive keyword analysis: Positive signals include Latin, History, Humanities, CAPSTONE, IHP (5 signals). 0 negative signals observed. Why this rating: Strong liberal-arts orientation via humanities and language study, but missing explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric sequence and Great Books signals in public content.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: No explicit public materials describing Socratic seminars, scholé days, or rest-focused contemplative pedagogy; no clear mention of chanting/memory rhythms in lower grades in the public content; most pedagogy claims are not described. Positive keyword analysis: 0 positive pedagogy signals clearly identified; 0 negative signals clearly identified in the observed material. Why this rating: Absence of explicit classical pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic dialogue, memory work, ritualized chant) in the public content.
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: There is a formal Faculty & Staff Directory with named roles (Headmaster, deans, Latin teacher, Humanities teachers, CAPSTONE advisor) indicating a structured, mentorship-focused faculty. However, the public text does not explicitly describe faculty as “living curriculum” or “models of virtue.” Positive keyword analysis: Positive signals appear in role clarity and specialized teaching (Latin, Humanities, CAPSTONE). 2–3 positive signals; 0 explicit negative signals in the observed content. Why this rating: Some alignment with classical faculty expectations (specialization, leadership roles) but lacking explicit language about virtue-modeling or “living curriculum.”
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: Active parent-facing materials exist (Prospective Parent Tour; Family Handbook; attendance and events pages; book fairs; open campus signals). These show engagement and parental involvement, which map to the classical-school emphasis on parent partnership and formation. Positive keyword analysis: Positive signals include “Prospective Parent Tour,” Family Handbook, open events and family involvement (3–4 signals). 1–3 explicit positive signals depending on interpretation; 0 explicit negative signals. Why this rating: Strong parent-and-community engagement, but the public materials do not show a formalized “parents as co-teachers” framework in explicit language.

Overall aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: Across the six categories, Valor North Austin demonstrates a credible classical-leaning curriculum and program (notably through Latin, history, humanities offerings, and a CLT10 pathway) but falls short of a full classical-pedagogy and religious/metaphysical framing in its public-facing content. The absence of explicit theology, liturgy, and a clearly articulated telos for virtue formation, plus the lack of publicly described Socratic pedagogy or Great Books in the observed pages, lead to a predominantly SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment with two categories dipping toward NOT CLASSICAL (Religious Foundations and Pedagogy). The balance of scores across the six categories yields an overall SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation.

What Would Move the Needle

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1)
- Add explicit, public language tying education to transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and theology or liturgical life as a foundational element; include targeted communications about mission-driven

formation and moral aims.

- Include a brief, public outline of the school's religious or existential commitments (even if ecumenical) to anchor the formation telos.
- School Purpose and Goal (Element 2)
- Publish a clear telos statement prioritizing virtue and wisdom formation over workforce preparation, with explicit commitments to the true/good/beautiful as real and knowable.
- Integrate language about scholé, contemplation, and the cultivation of human excellence in public-facing materials.
- Curriculum (Element 3)
- Publicly articulate a clear Trivium-inspired framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books or Great Conversation components; specify how history appears across disciplines as continuous study rather than as social studies.
- Explicitly connect existing programs (IHP, CAPSTONE) to a broader classical-curriculum plan and outline how Latin/history/humanities map to the full classical curriculum.
- Pedagogy (Element 4)
- Introduce and publicly describe a rigorous classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars in upper grades; memory work and recitation; scholé days; disciplined rhetoric and speech work) and offer examples or course descriptions.
- If not present, pilot and showcase a classical pedagogy in select grades to demonstrate alignment with the rubric.
- Faculty (Element 5)
- Publish a formal "living curriculum" statement for faculty, including a portrait of the teacher as mentor and virtuous exemplar; highlight professional development in classical pedagogy and ongoing collaborative culture among teachers.
- Parents & Community (Element 6)
- Expand explicit programs that treat parents as co-teachers (family liturgies, book studies, classical book clubs) and create more visible, structured opportunities for parent formation and involvement beyond tours and handbooks.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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